



WIND TURBINE BLADES BEING LOADED
AT VOC PORT TERMINAL.



Mr. Susanta Kumar Purohit, IRSSE,
Chairperson,
V. O. Chidambaram Port Authority

PORT WITH PURPOSE: A CONVERSATION WITH THE CHAIRPERSON OF VOC PORT

Question 1: Let us begin with the Outer Harbour project. The global tender was recently floated under the Hybrid Annuity Mode. Could you give us the latest status?

Shri Susanta Kumar Purohit: Yes, we issued the global tender for the Outer Harbour Development Project on 26 December 2025, valued at approximately ₹14,690 crores to be executed under Hybrid Annuity Mode (HAM) and DBFOT mode. We moved to HAM from the earlier DBFOT model because it better allocates construction and revenue risks between the government and the developer, making the project far more attractive to serious investors.

This follows the visionary foundation stone laid by the *Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi in February 2024, which signalled the Government of India's strong commitment to transforming VOC Port into a major east-coast transshipment hub.*

The project comprises two deep-draft container terminals, each with a 1,000-metre quay and 18-metre draft, ultimately adding capacity for four million TEUs per annum. Prospective bidders have until 7th January to submit queries, with a hybrid pre-application conference scheduled for 8 January. Tender documents remain available until 9th February. We are confident this structure will draw strong, credible bids and allow us to commence construction without undue delay.

Question-2: What measures are being taken to increase capacity in the interim, before the Outer Harbour becomes operational?

Shri Susanta Kumar Purohit: While the Outer Harbour remains our long-term flagship project to transform V.O. Chidambaram Port into a major transshipment hub on the east coast, the Port is simultaneously and proactively strengthening its existing infrastructure. A series of capacity augmentation initiatives have recently been completed to meet the growing needs of trade.

Key developments include the Tuticorin International Container Terminal, operated by JM Baxi, with a handling capacity of 6 lakh TEUs; North Cargo Berth-III with a capacity of 7 million tonnes for bulk cargo; capital dredging in front of North Cargo Berth-III to achieve a draft of 14.20 metres; expansion of the port turning circle from 488 metres to 550 metres; commissioning of a link conveyor system connecting Coal Jetty-1 to the coal yard; deployment of additional Harbour Mobile Cranes; and induction of a 60-tonne bollard pull tug. All these initiatives were completed in record time, significantly enhancing the Port's ability to handle higher volumes of container and bulk cargo.

In addition, construction of Multi-Cargo Berth No. 10, with a capacity of 6.6 million tonnes per annum, has commenced and is scheduled for completion by August 2026. The Port has also initiated the process of widening the entrance channel from 153 metres to 230 metres to accommodate larger vessels. Collectively, these upgrades support the Port's fiscal year target of handling 50 million tonnes of cargo and one million TEUs.

Questions-3: The port's pioneering green hydrogen initiatives have also drawn national attention. How do these align with the broader vision of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways?

Shri Susanta Kumar Purohit: Under the dynamic leadership and guidance of the Hon'ble Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Shri Sarbananda Sonowal, *VOC Port has become India's first port to produce and utilise green hydrogen on-site.* In September 2025 we commissioned a 10 Nm³/hr pilot plant (Cost-₹3.87 crore), now powering streetlighting and an EV charging station in the port colony.



GREEN HYDROGEN PRODUCTION FACILITY